

Facing the Taj Mahal from the great gate. Picture by Shobhit Gosain.

The Turkic influence on the structure is even more subtle, given the relative paucity of architectural tradition amongst the nomadic peoples of Central Asia. In fact, most of the grandest buildings in modern Central Asia are of a Persian-influence style in places like Bukhara and Samarkhand. The Turkic influence is not to be seen in the buildings themselves but rather the fact that the tombs are placed at the hearts of gardens, unlike any in the Persian tradition. The Mughals, perhaps drawing upon Central Asian traditions of burial out-of-doors, developed distinctive tomb-gardens, of which the Taj is the most celebrated example.

The Taj as an Influence

While numerous artistic trends flowed into the imaginations of the Taj's creators, any building of such scale, fame and grandeur must in turn influence later works. One of the greatest effects of the Taj Mahal has been as a poster child for Indian and Mughal architecture to the world; as one of the world's most iconic buildings, there is no modern student of the design or history of buildings that is not familiar with it.